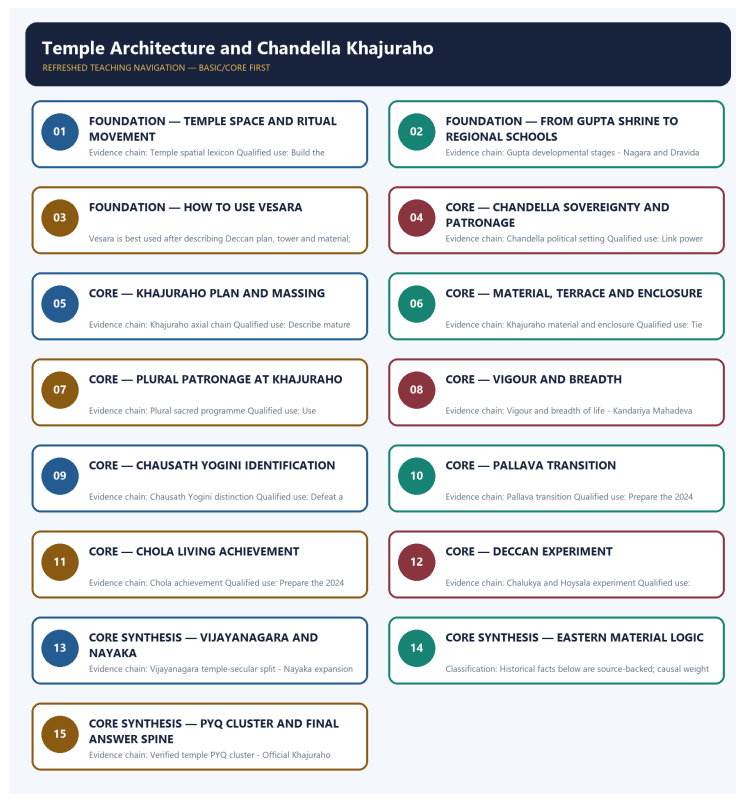


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Temple Architecture and Chandella Khajuraho - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Temple Architecture and Chandella Khajuraho - Solved Practice Workbook 6

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 6

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Temple spatial lexicon?	6
Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Temple spatial lexicon?	6
Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Temple spatial lexicon?	6
Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Temple spatial lexicon?	6
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Gupta developmental stages?	7
Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Gupta developmental stages?	7
Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gupta developmental stages?	7
Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gupta developmental stages?	7
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Nagara and Dravida?	8
Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Nagara and Dravida?	8
Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nagara and Dravida?	8
Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nagara and Dravida?	8
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Vesara caution?	8
Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Vesara caution?	9
Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vesara caution?	9
Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vesara caution?	9
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Chandella political setting?	9
Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Chandella political setting?	9
Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chandella political setting?	10
Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chandella political setting?	10
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Khajuraho axial chain?	10
Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Khajuraho axial chain?	10
Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Khajuraho axial chain?	10
Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Khajuraho axial chain?	11
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Khajuraho material and enclosure?	11
Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Khajuraho material and enclosure?	11
Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Khajuraho material and enclosure?	11

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Khajuraho material and enclosure?	12
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Plural sacred programme?	12
Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Plural sacred programme?	12
Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Plural sacred programme?	12
Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Plural sacred programme?	13
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Vigour and breadth of life?	13
Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Vigour and breadth of life?	13
Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vigour and breadth of life?	13
Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vigour and breadth of life?	14
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Kandariya Mahadeva?	14
Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Kandariya Mahadeva?	14
Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Kandariya Mahadeva?	14
Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Kandariya Mahadeva?	15
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Chausath Yogini distinction?	15
Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Chausath Yogini distinction?	15
Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chausath Yogini distinction?	15
Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chausath Yogini distinction?	16
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Pallava transition?	16
Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Pallava transition?	16
Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pallava transition?	16
Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pallava transition?	17
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Chola achievement?	17
Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Chola achievement?	17
Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chola achievement?	17
Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chola achievement?	18
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?	18
Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?	18
Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?	18
Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?	19
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Vijayanagara temple-secular split?	19
Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Vijayanagara temple-secular split?	19
Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vijayanagara temple-secular split?	19

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vijayanagara temple-secular split?	20
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Nayaka expansion?	20
Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Nayaka expansion?	20
Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nayaka expansion?	20
Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nayaka expansion?	21
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Pala-Sena eastern school?	21
Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Pala-Sena eastern school?	21
Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pala-Sena eastern school?	21
Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pala-Sena eastern school?	22
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Verified temple PYQ cluster?	22
Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified temple PYQ cluster?	22
Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified temple PYQ cluster?	22
Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified temple PYQ cluster?	23
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Official Khajuraho linkage?	23
Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Official Khajuraho linkage?	23
Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Official Khajuraho linkage?	23
Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Official Khajuraho linkage?	24
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Temple answer spine?	24
Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Temple answer spine?	24
Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Temple answer spine?	24
Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Temple answer spine?	25
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	25
VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT	25
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	25
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 GS-I	27
PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 GS-I	27
PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 GS-I	27
PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I	27
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	28
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	28
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	28
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	28

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS 29

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS 29

Temple Architecture and Chandella Khajuraho - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Temple spatial lexicon?

A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. B. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. C. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: A. Explanation: Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Temple spatial lexicon?

A. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. B. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.

Answer: B. Explanation: Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Temple spatial lexicon?

A. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. B. A high jagati supports ardhamandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. D. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.

Answer: C. Explanation: Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Temple spatial lexicon?

A. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. B. A high jagati supports ardhamandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: D. Explanation: Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Gupta developmental stages?

A. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.

Answer: A. Explanation: Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Gupta developmental stages?

A. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. B. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. C. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: B. Explanation: Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gupta developmental stages?

A. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. B. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. D. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gupta developmental stages?

A. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: D. Explanation: Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Nagara and Dravida?

A. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. B. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Nagara and Dravida?

A. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nagara and Dravida?

A. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. D. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nagara and Dravida?

A. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Vesara caution?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: A. Explanation: Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Vesara caution?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.

Answer: B. Explanation: Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vesara caution?

A. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: C. Explanation: Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vesara caution?

A. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. D. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.

Answer: D. Explanation: Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Chandella political setting?

A. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. D. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Chandella political setting?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chandella political setting?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chandella political setting?

A. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Khajuraho axial chain?

A. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: A. Explanation: A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Khajuraho axial chain?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: B. Explanation: A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Khajuraho axial chain?

A. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. B. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. C. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. D. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena.

Answer: C. Explanation: A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Khajuraho axial chain?

A. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.

Answer: D. Explanation: A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Khajuraho material and enclosure?

A. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. B. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom.

Answer: A. Explanation: Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Khajuraho material and enclosure?

A. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: B. Explanation: Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Khajuraho material and enclosure?

A. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: C. Explanation: Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Khajuraho material and enclosure?

A. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim.

Answer: D. Explanation: Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Plural sacred programme?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyālas and maithuna create breadth. C. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: A. Explanation: Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Plural sacred programme?

A. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. D. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena.

Answer: B. Explanation: Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Plural sacred programme?

A. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. D. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.

Answer: C. Explanation: Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Plural sacred programme?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. C. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. D. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom.

Answer: D. Explanation: Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Vigour and breadth of life?

A. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena.

Answer: A. Explanation: Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Vigour and breadth of life?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. C. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. D. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Answer: B. Explanation: Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vigour and breadth of life?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. C. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. D. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Answer: C. Explanation: Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vigour and breadth of life?

A. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: D. Explanation: Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Kandariya Mahadeva?

A. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. D. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.

Answer: A. Explanation: The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Kandariya Mahadeva?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. C. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. D. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Answer: B. Explanation: The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Kandariya Mahadeva?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: C. Explanation: The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Kandariya Mahadeva?

A. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: D. Explanation: The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Chausath Yogini distinction?

A. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: A. Explanation: Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Chausath Yogini distinction?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. D. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone.

Answer: B. Explanation: Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chausath Yogini distinction?

A. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. B. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. C. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: C. Explanation: Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chausath Yogini distinction?

A. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. B. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. C. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. D. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena.

Answer: D. Explanation: Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Pallava transition?

A. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: A. Explanation: Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Pallava transition?

A. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pallava transition?

A. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. D. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone.

Answer: C. Explanation: Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pallava transition?

A. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Answer: D. Explanation: Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Chola achievement?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: A. Explanation: Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Chola achievement?

A. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. B. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. C. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. D. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls.

Answer: B. Explanation: Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chola achievement?

A. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls.

Answer: C. Explanation: Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chola achievement?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.

Answer: D. Explanation: Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?

A. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.

Answer: A. Explanation: Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?

A. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. B. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.

Answer: B. Explanation: Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. B. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. C. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. D. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.

Answer: C. Explanation: Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: D. Explanation: Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Vijayanagara temple-secular split?

A. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. B. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. C. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. D. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Answer: A. Explanation: Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Vijayanagara temple-secular split?

A. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Answer: B. Explanation: Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vijayanagara temple-secular split?

A. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. B. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. C. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. D. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management.

Answer: C. Explanation: Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vijayanagara temple-secular split?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone.

Answer: D. Explanation: Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Nayaka expansion?

A. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Nayaka expansion?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nayaka expansion?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. B. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nayaka expansion?

A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. B. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. D. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Pala-Sena eastern school?

A. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. B. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order.

Answer: A. Explanation: Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Pala-Sena eastern school?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: B. Explanation: Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pala-Sena eastern school?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. C. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: C. Explanation: Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pala-Sena eastern school?

A. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. B. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. C. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. D. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.

Answer: D. Explanation: Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Verified temple PYQ cluster?

A. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. B. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. C. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified temple PYQ cluster?

A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. B. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. D. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified temple PYQ cluster?

A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified temple PYQ cluster?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. D. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Official Khajuraho linkage?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. B. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. C. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: A. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Official Khajuraho linkage?

A. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. B. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. C. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. D. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram.

Answer: B. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Official Khajuraho linkage?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: C. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Official Khajuraho linkage?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management.

Answer: D. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Temple answer spine?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. C. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. D. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram.

Answer: A. Explanation: A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Temple answer spine?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. C. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: B. Explanation: A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Temple answer spine?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: C. Explanation: A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Temple answer spine?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order.

Answer: D. Explanation: A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Verified owned Mains routes are the 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand, and the routed 2022 demand on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence. The 2026 objective route remains provisionally keyed and is not solved.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

7. Exact PYQ application

FACT: 2025 Q3, verbatim: "The sculptors filled the Chandella artform with resilient vigor and breadth of life.' Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words)" (UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 1.txt:14-18). **ANALYSIS:** A 150-word answer should: (i) name Khajuraho/Chandella Nagara architecture briefly; (ii) show "resilient vigour" through the dynamism of figural sculpture - dancers, musicians, divine and secular figures, mithuna couples, Vyalas - in active, twisting postures rather than static poses; (iii) show "breadth of life" through the sculptural programme's range (deities, courtly life, ascetics, animals, erotic imagery as one part among many); (iv) close by naming Kandariya Mahadeva as the culminating example and the 1986 UNESCO inscription as the current-status anchor.

FACT: 2024 Q2, verbatim: "Estimate the contribution of Pallavas of Kanchi for the development of art and literature of South India. (Answer in 150 words)" (UPSC Mains 2024 GS Paper I.txt:15-20). **ANALYSIS:** Answer should cite: Pallava temple architecture beginning under Mahendravarman I (610-630 AD); A.H. Longhurst's four chronological styles (Mahendravarman, Mamalla, Rajasimha, Nandivarman); the Mahabalipuram monolithic Pancha Rathas and Shore Temple (UNESCO 1984); Kanchipuram as capital and centre of Sanskrit scholarship (Dandin's *Avantisundari Katha*) - literature contribution belongs jointly to topic 11.

FACT: 2024 Q11, verbatim: "Though the great Cholas are no more yet their name is still remembered with great pride because of their highest achievements in the domain of art and architecture. Comment. (Answer in 250 words)" (UPSC Mains 2024 GS Paper I.txt:77-82). **ANALYSIS:** Answer should cite: Brihadishvara Temple, Thanjavur (built by Rajaraja I in the early eleventh century, also called Rajarajeshvara, Periya Kovil and Dakshina Meru) - a fully granite temple with a huge vimana that the book describes as about 60 m tall; the "Great Living Chola Temples" UNESCO inscription (Thanjavur 1987; Gangaikondacholapuram and Darasuram added 2004); Chola bronze sculpture, especially the Nataraja (developed fully in topic 06); the elaborate temple-administration Tamil inscription at Airavatesvara Temple as evidence of institutional sophistication. **WRONG:** Do not quote a decimal vimana height or a precise consecration year: this folder's sources support "early 11th century" and "about 60 m," and any more exact figure must come from a separately cited dated source.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	4	Nagara-style shikhara among early Indian temple architecture examples	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - 2026 - GS1 - Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Nagara-style shikhara among early Indian temple architecture examples

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	11	Cholas' achievements in art and architecture	Comment · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2025	GS-I	3	Chandella artform - resilient vigour and breadth of life	Elucidate · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Cholas' achievements in art and architecture
- Chandella artform - resilient vigour and breadth of life

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2021
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	Prelims GS-I	31	Chausath Yogini Temple Morena Kachchhapaghata architecture	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Chausath Yogini Temple Morena Kachchhapaghata architecture

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

8. Exact PYQ application

FACT: **2025 Q3, verbatim:** "The sculptors filled the Chandella artform with resilient vigor and breadth of life."

Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words)" (UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 1.txt:14-18). ANALYSIS: **Advanced-tier answer architecture:** (i) name Dhanga's political autonomy as the enabling condition for ambitious temple patronage; (ii) define "resilient vigour" through the dynamic, muscular, multi-postured figural style across the **entire** programme; (iii) define "breadth of life" through the programme's range (deities, secular life, ascetics, animals, intimacy) and the plural Shaiva-Vaishnava-Jain patronage as evidence of "life" in its full civilisational sense, not only erotic content; (iv) close with Kandariya Mahadeva as the culminating case and the 1986 UNESCO inscription as the current-status anchor - all within 150 words, which requires tight, non-redundant phrasing.

FACT: **2024 Q11 (Cholas), cross-reference:** the Great Living Chola Temples' comparative vimana/gopuram model (Section 3) supplies a contrast case for any answer that must distinguish Nagara (Khajuraho) from Dravida (Chola) achievement in the same essay.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 GS-I

Demand: 'The sculptors filled the Chandella artform with resilient vigor and breadth of life.' Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words)

Status: Verified verbatim in the Basic owner.

Model solution: Separate vigour as carving method from breadth as subject range; cite sandstone, dynamic figures, sacred and secular registers, vyālas and maithuna as one element; close with Kandariya Mahadeva.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 GS-I

Demand: Estimate the contribution of Pallavas of Kanchi for the development of art and literature of South India. (Answer in 150 words)

Status: Verified verbatim in the Basic owner.

Model solution: Estimate the rock-cut to monolithic to structural sequence through Mandagapattu, Pancha Rathas and Shore Temple, then add Kanchipuram, murals, inscriptions and Dandin with a survival limitation.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 GS-I

Demand: Though the great Cholas are no more yet their name is still remembered with great pride because of their highest achievements in the domain of art and architecture. Comment. (Answer in 250 words)

Status: Verified verbatim in the Basic owner.

Model solution: Use Brihadishvara for granite scale, Nataraja for bronze, murals and inscriptions for cultural-administrative depth, and the living UNESCO serial property for afterlife; qualify labour and incomplete survivals.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I

Demand: Medieval Indian temple sculptures represent the social life of those days. How will you explain this statement?

Status: Verified routed wording in the Core owner.

Model solution: Use dancers and musicians, teachers and disciples, courtly scenes, patron women and named artisans as selected evidence; state that commissioned images are representations, not a statistical photograph of society.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Elucidate the resilient vigour and breadth of life in Chandella art. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Khajuraho's vigour comes from dynamic carving integrated with sandstone walls; breadth comes from its sacred, social, animal, performance and intimate registers, of which maithuna is only one.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.
- Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim.
- Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom.
- Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.
- The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Qualified conclusion: Khajuraho's vigour comes from dynamic carving integrated with sandstone walls; breadth comes from its sacred, social, animal, performance and intimate registers, of which maithuna is only one.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Estimate the Pallava contribution to South Indian art and architecture. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The Pallava achievement was a transition from excavated mandapas to monolithic experiments and structural temples, joined to mural and Sanskrit-Tamil literary patronage.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Qualified conclusion: The Pallava achievement was a transition from excavated mandapas to monolithic experiments and structural temples, joined to mural and Sanskrit-Tamil literary patronage.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Why are the Cholas remembered for art and architecture? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Monumental granite building, portable bronzes, murals, inscriptions, administration and continuing worship survive together, giving Chola patronage both scale and living afterlife.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.

Qualified conclusion: Monumental granite building, portable bronzes, murals, inscriptions, administration and continuing worship survive together, giving Chola patronage both scale and living afterlife.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Temple sculpture is selected evidence of medieval social life. Explain. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Performance, learning, courtly activity, ritual and labour appear in commissioned programmes, but representation records what patrons made visible rather than society statistically.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.
- The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Qualified conclusion: Performance, learning, courtly activity, ritual and labour appear in commissioned programmes, but representation records what patrons made visible rather than society statistically.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Trace the development of South Indian temple architecture from Pallava to Nayaka. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The organising movement is rock-cut to structural temple, imperial vimana, Deccan experiment, gateway-dominated Vijayanagara complex and Nayaka enclosure expansion.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.
- Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.
- Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.
- Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone.
- Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls.

Qualified conclusion: The organising movement is rock-cut to structural temple, imperial vimana, Deccan experiment, gateway-dominated Vijayanagara complex and Nayaka enclosure expansion.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Compare major regional schools of Indian temple architecture. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Nagara, Dravida, Deccan and eastern schools differ through tower, enclosure, plan, material and patronage; named monuments reveal a family of regional solutions, not rigid boxes.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram.
- Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.
- A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.
- Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.
- Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.
- A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order.

Qualified conclusion: Nagara, Dravida, Deccan and eastern schools differ through tower, enclosure, plan, material and patronage; named monuments reveal a family of regional solutions, not rigid boxes.